

Q.6b (15 marks): Single definition of marriage cannot be applied to all cultures

6. (b) "विवाह की एक ही परिभाषा सभी संस्कृतियों पर लागू नहीं की जा सकती।" उदाहरणों सहित विवचना कीजिए।
 "A single definition of marriage cannot be applied to all cultures." Discuss with examples. 15

इस हार्डिंग में
नहीं लिखना
चाहिए
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write on
this margin

Marriage is characterised as a ~~single~~ universal institution which is present in all societies in one form or the other.

Since a long time there have been many efforts to devise a single universal definition of marriage.

VARIOUS DEFINITIONS OF MARRIAGE ÷

- 1) George Murdock defined marriage as a social institution which involves
- residential cohabitation
 - economic cooperation
 - formation of a nuclear family

CRITICISM ÷

- (i) Residential Cohabitation not followed in all cultures.

eg Nayars of Kerala → husband and wife don't live together.

उम्मीदवारों को इस हाशिए में नहीं लिखना चाहिए
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- 2) Westermarck defined marriage as :
"a ritually and socially recognized bond between a male and female who have mutually exclusive sexual rights over one another".

CRITICISM :

- (i) Male and female bond doesn't apply everywhere.

eg Female-Female marriages among the Nuers of South Sudan

- (ii) Mutually exclusive sexual rights not always. In some cultures extra-marital sexual relations are allowed.

eg Yanomami of Amazon.

- 3) Kathaleen Gough defined marriage as : "a relation between a woman and one or more other person, where

offsprings born out of such union get the social status"

CRITICISM :-

i) Ignores Male-Male Marriages

eg Prevalent among the chuckchee of Siberia

ii) Ignores single parent relation

eg Basoga of Central America — high divorce rates.

④ Stephen defines marriage as an institution that begins with a public proclamation and involves lifelong ties

CRITICISM :-

i) Does not take into account the fact that marriage not always with social proclamation eg Ghost marriage in Sudan (in secrecy)

In Contemporary times, with the coming of same sex marriages and live in relations → universal definition become more difficult.